System and Level Design Master Doc

Pipeline

1. **Create Documentation Page**
    a. A page within the document detailing General Narrative, Asset List, Concept Art/Reference Images, and any unique feature elements.
2. **Approved by Artists and Designers**
    a. The documentation page is approved and signed off by the Artists and Designers
3. **Designer Blockout/Artist Asset Creation**
    a. Concurrently, the levels are blocked out while artists create the assets.
4. **Artist Implementation and Hero Shot (Beautiful Corner)**
    a. Once the assets are created, artists implement them and place them in the Beautiful Corner for review

Train Cars

General Gameplay Mechanics

Flow:

There are two encounters per train phase, each in its own pool. Pool 1 will have encounters centered around killing and surviving. Pool 2 will have encounters centered around the mechanics of defending/capturing a point. When entering an encounter, a trigger will close the door behind you, and the player will then need to interact with a terminal that has triggers that activate a specific encounter (i.e., different named terminal assets that all have trigger boxes of specific encounters)

Encounters:

Pool 1 - 3 layouts (small variation)

Survival Stage

Level Overview

The player must survive within the level for a fixed duration until the exit opens.

Level Details

Win / Lose Conditions

Victory Condition:

- The player reaches the exit within the designated time.

Failure Condition:

- The player dies during the stage.

Stage Start Rules

Countdown Start

- The countdown begins when the player enters the stage.

Exit Rules

- When the countdown reaches zero, the exit opens.
- After the exit opens, enemies keep spawning until play leaves

- Elite Enemy (Stretch)
    - Beefier enemies that are like the regular enemy (model), but a tiny bit bigger and have more health
    - High Health (extra attack?) vs regular enemy

Pool 2 - 2 layouts for each encounter (4 total)

Defense Stage

Level Overview

Once the device is activated, enemies will be attracted to it and attempt to destroy it. The player must protect the device from taking damage within a limited number of waves.

Level Details

Win / Lose Conditions

Victory Condition:

- All enemies are eliminated
- Device HP > 0
- Player is alive
  If all three conditions are met, the mission is completed successfully.

Failure Condition:

- Device HP ≤ 0 within the designated waves
  OR
- The player dies

Settlement

Victory:

- The exit to the next stage opens.

Failure:

- Game Over
- The player respawns at the starting point and begins a new run.

Stage Start Rules

Activation：

A device that must be defended is placed in the level. When the player interacts with the device by pressing **F**, the first wave of enemies begins.

Wave System

Wave Display

- When the stage begins, the center of the screen displays:
  Current Wave: 1/X
    - 1 = current wave number
    - X = total wave count
- Each time a new wave begins, a UI notification appears for X seconds.

Wave Spawn Rules

- When a wave begins, a countdown starts.
- After each countdown ends, the next wave spawns automatically.
- The next wave spawns regardless of whether the current wave has been fully cleared.

Device Rules

Damage

- The device loses HP when attacked by enemies.
- The device does not regenerate HP.
- The device has no damage reduction.

Capture Point Stage

Level Overview

When the player enters the capture zone, the capture point begins charging and a countdown starts.
The player must fully charge the capture point before the timer reaches zero.

Level Details

Win / Lose Conditions

Victory Condition:

- The capture progress bar reaches 100% within the time limit.

Failure Condition:

- The timer reaches zero and progress is below 100%
  OR
- The player dies

Settlement

Victory:

- All enemies currently in the area must be eliminated.

- Enemy spawning stops.
- Enemies drop materials normally.

Failure:

- Game Over
- The player respawns at the starting point and begins a new run.

Stage Start Rules

Capture Start

- When the player enters the capture area and the progress bar begins increasing,
    - The countdown timer starts.
    - Enemies begin spawning.

Capture Rules

Progress Increase

- While the player remains inside the capture area,
    - The progress bar increases at a rate of X points per second.
    - The total required progress is X points.
    - Progress does not increase beyond the maximum value.

Progress Decrease

- When the player leaves the capture area,
    - The progress bar decreases at X points per second.
    - Progress decreases until it reaches 0.
    -

Intro Level

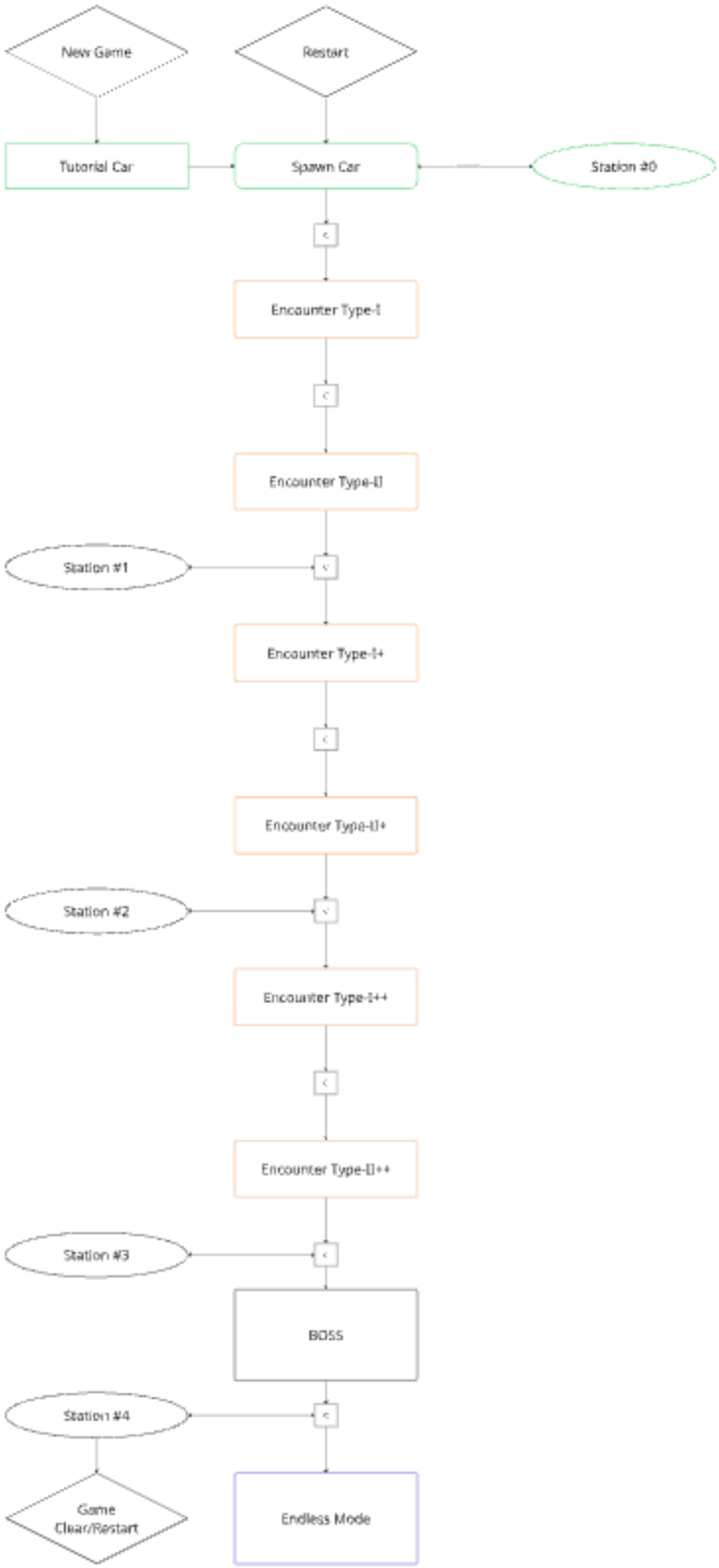
- Tutorial Car
    - The player wakes up in the corner
    - Must pick up a weapon to start the encounter
    - Player will navigate the car learning mechanics (traps, temporary buffs), shooting calibration, and movement (crouching, jumping)
- Spawn Car
    - Player accesses the tutorial train station, where they discover puzzles, crafting, and the shop, as well as an item that unlocks the meta progression stations and “activates” the spawn car.
    - This essentially allows the player to start a run as they normally would after a death.
    - Access to the Armory, where players can choose loadouts, and a separate station to upgrade their meta progression
    - Player respawns in this car every time they die
- Narrative
    - *The player is repairing a few RATs in the caboose of the train. This room is a sort of living quarters/repair room. As the player steps away to grab a new tool, the lights flicker and dim. The radio turns to static. The RATs start twitching, and the player reaches for their gun. The game starts and the player must shoot the RATs before they get killed. Upon defeating them, there’s a slight jerk as the train stops, a PA announces the train has arrived at the station, and the door opens to a station. Player is confused and attempts to reach command, but no response.*
    - *The player explores a station, unsure of what is going on. There's a massive machine sparking and degrading*
    - *They step back onto the train, the doors close behind them, and the train starts to move. Before they can do anything, a rumble and a flash of light knocks the player down, the stunned player stands ups, and the door to the next car opens.*

Buff and Shop Cars - Connecting Cars

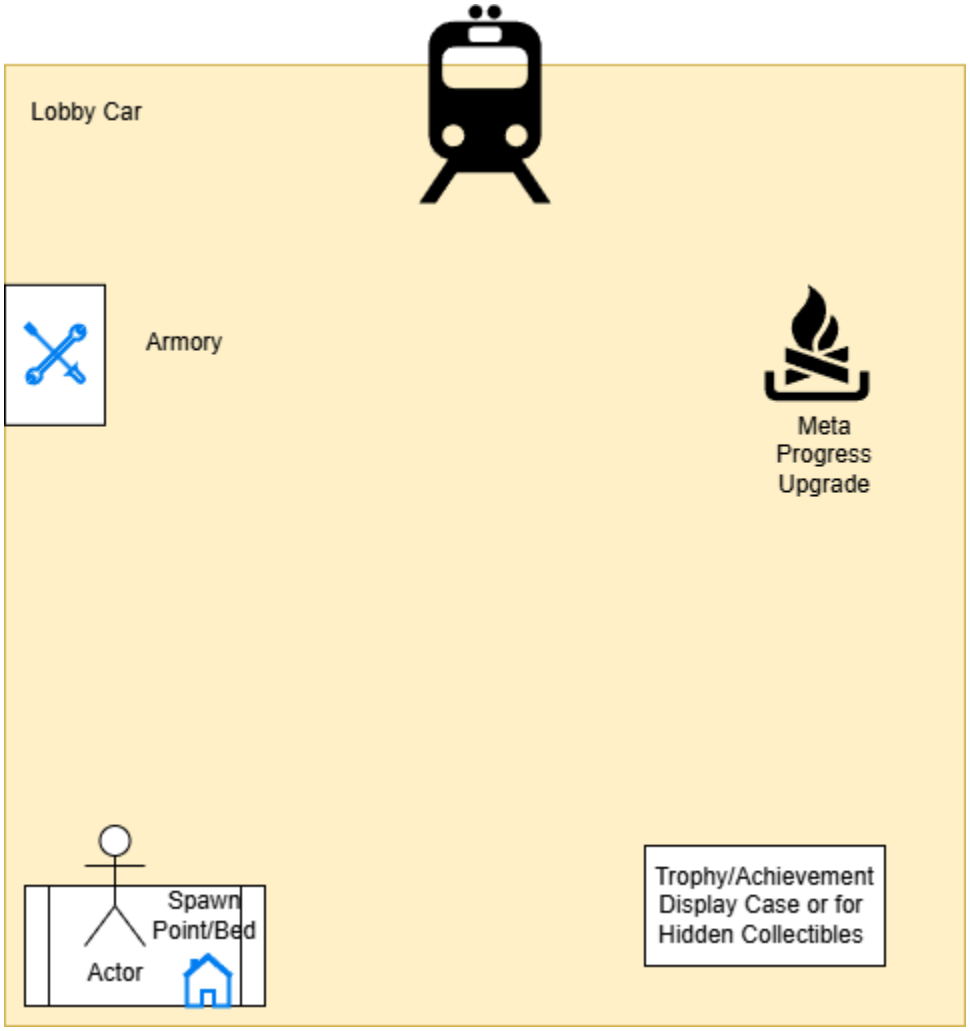
- In between encounters/cars, the Player chooses a buff from a small selection
- Rare chance for a shop to spawn ~10-20%?
- The player will only exit and enter the station through these cars, and will always be required to select a buff after an encounter is completed
    - This is what triggers opening the door to the next encounter or station

End Game

- Boss Car
- Endless Mode


New Game
Restart
Tutorial Car
Spawn Car
Station #0
Encounter Type-I
Encounter Type-II
Station #1
Encounter Type-I+
Encounter Type-II+
Station #2
Encounter Type-I++
Encounter Type-II++
Station #3
BOSS
Station #4
Game Clear/Restart
Endless Mode

Spawn Car



- Respawn after everyone (Not including tutorial)
- Upgrade metaprogression and choose a starting weapon loadout and buff
- Can't go directly to a train station, must start first train and its encounters

Train Station

General Gameplay Flow

- Exit Train
- Explore and Loot

- Craft
- Solve a Puzzle

- 8-minute time limit
    - Potentially add an endless wave of enemies if the player misses the train
        - The wave will get more difficult and end when the player dies.
    - Missing Train is a game-over/run-end
    - At 2 minutes player is allowed back on the train, either via dialogue through an intercom announcement or a short animation showing doors opening.
        - “The train is ready to depart
    - At 5 minutes, another dialogue
        - “The train is preparing to leave.”
    - At 7 minutes
        - “Last call, please make your way to the train.”

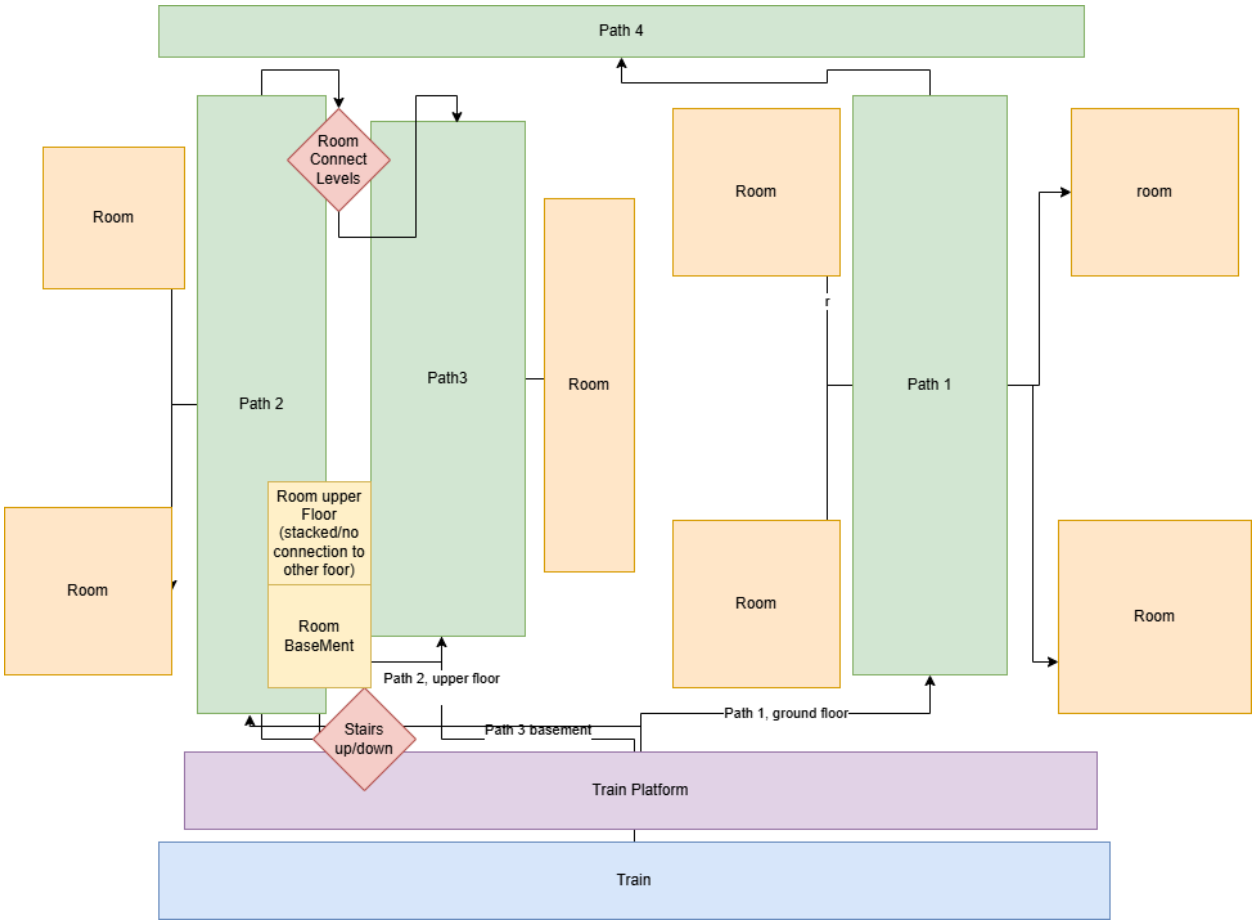
Tutorial Station

- Introduce the player to the basic Gameplay Flow systems like crafting, puzzle solving, and the shop
- Grab the device that unlocks meta progression
- 1 room to explore, based on solving a puzzle to get the Assault Rifle

Linear Station with 2 loops

- The Station progression will center around navigating down a path to find loot and solve puzzles as you progress down it. There will be certain elements of roadblocking that encourage the player to explore to find buttons are levels that extend the way forward. Getting to the end will allow a reward, but solving certain puzzles will unlock higher-tier rewards.
- Other paths will unlock based on things you find along one path.
    - The potential to lock players into one path to limit how much loot they can achieve if they run through the level
    - Designed in away the takes 6-8 minutes to solve one path
- Puzzles and looting
    - The rooms are linear, and the puzzles are spread throughout a loop rather than being tied to specific rooms
    - Various spawn points for rare loot and recipes with loot tables that will be tied to the number of stations that have been visited in a given run

Train Station Diagram



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Puzzles

- Puzzle 1: Shoot Targets
    - Player shoots 4 targets around the path, has to use movement abilities like crouch to navigate and find them.
    - Player unlocks the chest/door that contains the first permanent unlock
        - First Reward will be the Assault Rifle
- Puzzle 2: Find code
    - The player searches the path for 4 numbers, with the order being tied to their spawn locations based on the start to end of the path.

        - Keypad near a door with lazer grid? That will unlock once the code is entered correctly
            - The reward will be a weapon mod or crafting recipe
- Puzzle 3: Lever Puzzle
    - Find levels around the room to solve a lights-out puzzle
        - Similar to Borderlands 2 TNMT Easter egg puzzle

Looting

Looting and puzzles will now be seamless, with puzzles spanning a path rather than being tied to a room. Loot spawn points are being placed throughout the loop paths and adding branching sections to explore secret/hidden areas. There will be a percent chance for recipes and other loot to spawn (randomized/not always guaranteed). Once these recipes are unlocked, they are permanent (Encourage replability)

Documentation Pages Overview

Documentation Pages will cover a “train car pack” or grouping of levels. They will detail the following:

- General Narrative
    - What’s the setting trying to recreate? Any narrative aspects that should impact the visuals/gameplay?
- Unique Features
    - Any unique gameplay features? VFX notes? Visual Impacts?
- Concept Art/References
    - Any Concept Art/References to draw inspiration from (Both for the assets and the block outs)
- Asset List
    - List of the various assets, general dimensions, and any special notes.

Warehouse

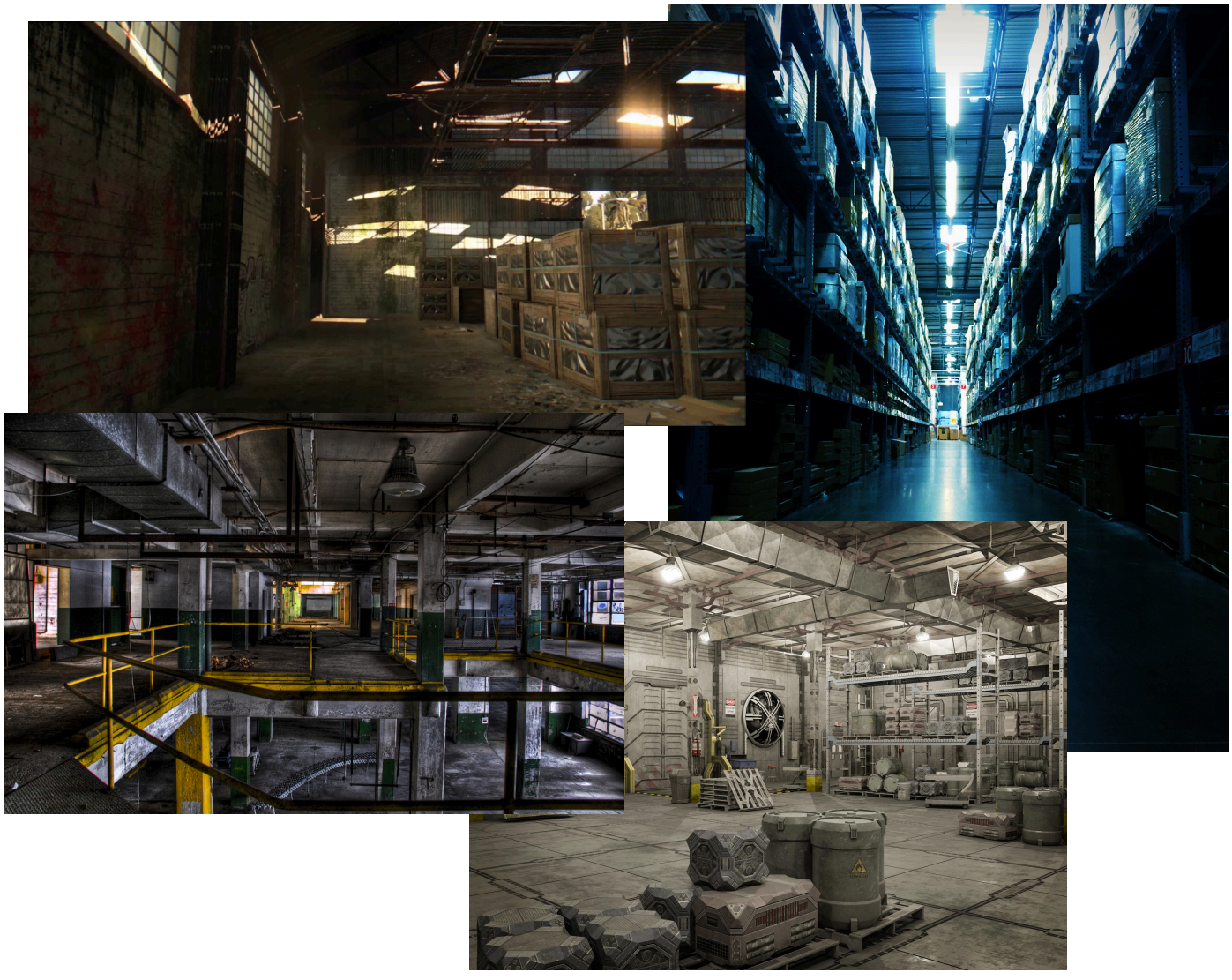
General Narrative

This is the original state of the train cars. They were used to transport high volumes of RATs (Robotic Assistants Technology units, aka the evil robots).

Unique Features

Currently, distortions would be purely visual. This could be low-lighting or assets from different Train Car Packs appearing

Concept Art/References



Level Design Assets

Asset	Assets Dimensions	Special Notes
Packaging		Some different Variations would be good
Shelving		
Lights		
Support Pillars/Beams		
Catwalk w/railing		
Stairs		
Pallets		